PROMISE & PRACTICE · GROWTH & CONFLICT · SOURCE ANALYSIS

Nauvoo

A city on a bend in the river

Name: _____ **Period:** _____ **Date:** _____

WHAT I CAN DO TODAY I can read primary sources about Nauvoo, weigh who made each one and why, and use evidence to answer historical questions.

THE SOURCES

THE RULE · 1791

> *"Congress shall make no law… abridging the freedom… of the press; or the right of the people peaceably to assemble, and to petition the Government for a redress of grievances."*

The First Amendment to the U.S. Constitution.

THE CITY'S CLAIM · 1844

PROSPECTUS

OF THE

NAUVOO EXPOSITOR.

The "Nauvoo Expositor" will be issued on Friday of each week, on an Imperial sheet, with a new Press and materials of the best quality, and rendered worthy of the patronage of a discerning and an enlightened public.

The Expositor will be devoted to a general diffusion of useful knowledge, and its columns open for the admission of all courteous Communications of a Religious, Moral, Social, Literary, or Political character, without taking a decided stand in favor of either of the great Political Parties of the country. A few of its columns will be devoted to a few primary objects, which the Publishers deem of vital importance to the public welfare. Their particular locality gives them a knowledge of the many **Gross abuses exercised under the "pretended" authorities of the Charter of the City of Nauvoo,** by the Legislative authorities of said city; and the *Iniquitous, Ille OPPRESSIONS of the MINISTERIAL powers, in carrying out the* Unjust, Illegal, and Unconstitutional *Ordinances of the same.* The Publishers, therefore, deem it a sacred duty they owe to their country and their fellow citizens, to advocate, through the columns of the Expositor, the **Unconditional REPEAL of the NAUVOO CITY CHARTER**—to restrain and correct the abuses of the UNIT POWER—to ward off the Iron Rod which is held over the devoted heads of the citizens of Nauvoo and the surrounding country—to advocate unmitigated *DISOBEDIENCE to POLITICAL REVELATIONS,* and to censure and decry gross moral imperfections wherever found, either in the Plebian, Patrician, or Self-Constituted MONARCH—to advocate the pure principles of morality, the pure principles of truth, designed not to destroy, but strengthen the main-spring of God's moral government—to advocate, and exercise, the freedom of speech in Nauvoo, independent of the ordinances abridging the same—to give *free toleration to every man's Religious sentiments,* and sustain ALL in worshiping their God according to the monitions of their consciences, as guaranteed by the Constitution of our country, and to oppose, with uncompromising hostility, any Union of CHURCH and STATE, or any preliminary step tending to the same—to *sustain ALL, however humble,* in their equal and Constitutional RIGHTS—and oppose the sacrifice of the Liberty, the Property, and the Happiness of the *MANY,* to the *Pride* and *Ambition* of the *FEW.* In a word, to give a full, candid, and succinct statement of FACTS, AS THEY REALLY EXIST IN THE CITY OF NAUVOO—*Fearless of whose particular case the facts may apply*—being governed by the laws of Editorial courtesy and the inherent dignity which is inseparable from honorable minds, at the same time exercising their own judgment in cases of flagrant abuses, or moral delinquencies—to use such terms and names as they deem proper, when the object is of such high importance that the end will justify the means. In this great and indispensable work, we confidently look to an enlightened public to aid us in our laudable effort.

The columns of the Expositor will be open to the discussion of all matters of public interest, the productions of all correspondents subject to the decision of the Editor alone, who shall receive or reject at his option. National questions will be in place—but no preference given to either of the political parties. The Editorial department will contain the political news of the day, proceedings of Congress, election returns, &c., &c. Room will be given for articles on Agriculture, the Mechanic Arts, Commercial transactions, &c.

The first number of the Expositor will be issued on Friday, the 7th day of June 1844. The publishers bind themselves to issue the paper weekly for one year, and forward 52 copies to each subscriber during the year. Orders should be forwarded as soon as possible, that the publishers may know what number of copies to issue.

The publishers take pleasure in announcing to the public; that they have engaged the services of Sylvester Emmans, Esq., who will have entire charge and supervision of the Editorial department. From an acquaintance with the dignity of character, and literary qualifications of this gentleman, they feel assured that the "Nauvoo Expositor" must and will sustain a high and honorable reputation.

TERMS of the "NAUVOO EXPOSITOR."

The Terms of the paper will be
$2,00 per annum, in advance.
$2,50 at the expiration of six months.
$3,00 at the end of the year.

Six copies will be forwarded to one address for $10,00 in advance—Thirteen copies for $20,00, &c., &c.

☞All Letters and Communications must be addressed to "Charles A. Foster, Nauvoo, Ill.," *post paid,* in order to insure attention.☜

WILLIAM LAW,
WILSON LAW,
CHARLES IVINS,
FRANCIS M. HIGBEE,
CHAUNCEY L. HIGBEE,
ROBERT D. FOSTER,
CHARLES A. FOSTER.
} Publishers.

Nauvoo, Ill., May 10th, 1844.

SUBSCRIBER'S NAMES.	POST OFFICE.	NUMBER OF COPIES.

> *The council declared the Expositor a "public nuisance" whose libels, they argued, would provoke mobs to descend on Nauvoo — so destroying it, they claimed, protected the city's safety*

The Nauvoo city council's stated reason for destroying the press.

YOUR WORK

A. WHO ORDERED THE DESTRUCTION OF THE EXPOSITOR, AND WHAT WAS THAT SAME PERSON'S RELATIONSHIP TO THE NEWSPAPER? WHY DOES THAT MATTER?

a. Who ordered the destruction of the Expositor, and what was that same person's relationship to the newspaper? Why does that matter?

B. WHAT REASON DID THE CITY GIVE FOR DESTROYING THE PRESS — IN ITS OWN WORD FOR IT?

b. What reason did the city give for destroying the press — in its own word for it?

A. THE FIRST AMENDMENT PROTECTS "FREEDOM OF THE PRESS." THE CITY CALLED THE PAPER A "PUBLIC NUISANCE." PUT THE CONFLICT IN ONE SENTENCE: WHAT DOES EACH SIDE SAY SHOULD WIN?

a. The First Amendment protects "freedom of the press." The city called the paper a "public nuisance." Put the conflict in one sentence: what does each side say should win?

B. IS THERE EVER A POINT WHERE SPEECH BECOMES SO DANGEROUS A COMMUNITY MAY STOP IT? WHERE WOULD YOU DRAW THAT LINE — AND DOES THE EXPOSITOR FALL ON YOUR SIDE OF IT?

b. Is there ever a point where speech becomes so dangerous a community may stop it? Where would you draw that line — and does the Expositor fall on your side of it?

THE MORMONS HAD THEMSELVES BEEN DRIVEN FROM MISSOURI BY MOBS AND LIES IN THE PRESS. HOW MIGHT THAT HISTORY EXPLAIN — NOT NECESSARILY EXCUSE — WHY THEY FEARED THIS NEWSPAPER ENOUGH TO DESTROY IT?

The Mormons had themselves been driven from Missouri by mobs and lies in the press. How might that history explain — not necessarily excuse — why they feared this newspaper enough to destroy it?

CLAIM — SHOULD THE CITY HAVE BEEN ALLOWED TO DESTROY THE EXPOSITOR? TAKE A CLEAR POSITION.

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EVIDENCE — AT LEAST TWO SPECIFICS FROM THE PRESENTATION AND THE TWO SOURCES THAT SUPPORT YOUR CLAIM.

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REASONING — A MOB THEN MURDERED JOSEPH SMITH IN JAIL. DOES THAT LATER VIOLENCE CHANGE HOW YOU JUDGE THE CITY'S ORIGINAL DECISION? WHY OR WHY NOT?

REASONING — a mob then murdered Joseph Smith in jail. Does that later violence change how you judge the city's original decision? Why or why not?

TEACHER ANSWER KEY — Nauvoo

a. Who ordered the destruction of the Expositor, and what was that same person's relationship to the newspaper? Why does that matter?: Open response.

b. What reason did the city give for destroying the press — in its own word for it?: Open response.

a. The First Amendment protects "freedom of the press." The city called the paper a "public nuisance." Put the conflict in one sentence: what does each side say should win?: Open response.

b. Is there ever a point where speech becomes so dangerous a community may stop it? Where would you draw that line — and does the Expositor fall on your side of it?: Open response.

The Mormons had themselves been driven from Missouri by mobs and lies in the press. How might that history explain — not necessarily excuse — why they feared this newspaper enough to destroy it?: Open response.

CLAIM — Should the city have been allowed to destroy the Expositor? Take a clear position.: Open response.

> *Look for a response along the lines of: "The city should / should not have …"*

EVIDENCE — at least two specifics from the presentation and the two sources that support your claim.: Open response.

REASONING — a mob then murdered Joseph Smith in jail. Does that later violence change how you judge the city's original decision? Why or why not?: Open response.